

what3words — Share Feature Test Cases

Platform explored: Android (physical device, what3words app v.installed build)

Method: Manual exploration via Appium (UiAutomator2 inspector) — see entry points below.

Entry points confirmed in the app

1. **Home screen** → **"Share" button** (bottom action sheet shown under the current 3-word address, alongside Navigate/Save/Chat). Confirmed behaviour: opens the Android share sheet with a message containing the **currently displayed 3-word address** and its short link, e.g.:

I'm sharing a what3words address to help you find this specific location. Tap to see exactly where it is:

///uniforms.plastic.aquatics

<https://w3w.co/uniforms.plastic.aquatics>

2. **Menu (hamburger/drawer)** → **"Share Locate Link"**. Confirmed behaviour: opens the Android share sheet with a **generic, address-independent** message:

Please click this link to see your current what3words address. To share your location, send the 3 words by text, or read them over the phone.

<https://locate.what3words.com/>

This link is **not** tied to whatever address is currently on screen — it resolves to the recipient's own location when they open it (a "help me find you" link, not "here's where I am"). This is a meaningfully different feature from #1 and should not be assumed to behave the same way.

Both entry points hand off to the **native Android share sheet** (`ACTION_SEND`), so the actual delivery to a target app (WhatsApp, LINE, Gmail, etc.) is OS/third-party behavior, not something what3words controls — test cases below scope assertions to what what3words itself is responsible for (invoking the share intent with the correct content) rather than what happens inside a third-party app after handoff.

Test Cases

ID	Title	Preconditions	Steps	Expected Result	Priority
SHARE-01	Share button is visible on Home screen	App launched, onboarding complete, a location (default GPS or previously searched) is displayed	1. Observe the bottom action sheet on the Home screen	"Share" button/icon is visible and labelled, alongside Navigate/Save/Chat	High
SHARE-02	Tap Share opens the native share sheet	Home screen displayed with a valid 3-word address	1. Tap "Share"	Android share sheet (chooser) opens, listing installed apps capable of receiving shared text (Messages, WhatsApp, Gmail, etc.)	High
SHARE-03	Shared message contains the exact current 3-word address	Home screen displaying address <code>///uniforms.plastic.aquatics</code> (or any known address)	1. Tap "Share" 2. Inspect the share-sheet content preview	Message body contains the literal 3-word address exactly as shown on the Home screen, no truncation or mismatch	High
SHARE-04	Shared message contains a correct, resolvable w3w.co short link	Same as SHARE-03	1. Tap "Share" 2. Inspect the content preview link	Link is in the form <code>https://w3w.co/<word1>.<word2>.<word3></code> and the 3 words exactly match the address in the message body	High
SHARE-05	Share reflects a newly searched address, not a stale one	Home screen showing address A	1. Search for and select a different location (address B) 2. Tap "Share"	Shared message/link reference address B, not address A — no caching/staleness	High
SHARE-06	Share after selecting a result from search	On Search page with results displayed	1. Tap a search result to land on its Home/detail view 2. Tap "Share"	Shared content matches the address of the selected result	Medium
SHARE-07	Cancelling the share sheet returns cleanly to Home	Share sheet open (via SHARE-02)	1. Press Back / tap outside the sheet	Share sheet dismisses; Home screen is unchanged, no crash, no duplicate address panel	Medium
SHARE-08	Selecting a target app hands off the correct pre-filled content	Share sheet open with address <code>///word.word.word</code>	1. Select a target app that supports pre-filled text (e.g. Messages)	Target app opens (or its compose screen) with the what3words message/link pre-filled unmodified	Medium
SHARE-09	Repeated Share taps do not duplicate the share sheet or corrupt content	Home screen displayed	1. Tap "Share" 2. Dismiss it 3. Tap "Share" again immediately, repeat 3–5 times	Each invocation opens exactly one share sheet with correct, un-corrupted content; no stacked/duplicate sheets, no ANR	Low
SHARE-10	Rotating the device while the share sheet is open	Share sheet open	1. Rotate device to landscape and back	Share sheet remains functional and correctly laid out; no crash; content unchanged after rotation	Low

ID	Title	Preconditions	Steps	Expected Result	Priority
SHARE-11	Share works with a non-English wordlist address	Home/search showing a non-English (e.g. Vietnamese) 3-word address, e.g. <code>///viết chữ.âm nhạc.an nhàn</code>	1. Tap "Share" 2. Inspect the content preview	Message and link correctly encode the non-Latin/diacritic wordlist text — no mojibake, no dropped characters, link still uses the correct word-encoded slug	High
SHARE-12	Menu → "Share Locate Link" is reachable	App launched, any screen with the drawer/menu accessible	1. Open the menu (hamburger icon) 2. Locate "Share Locate Link" entry	Entry is visible, labelled "Share Locate Link", and tappable	Medium
SHARE-13	"Share Locate Link" opens the native share sheet with the generic locate message	Menu open	1. Tap "Share Locate Link"	Share sheet opens with message referencing <code>https://locate.what3words.com/</code> and generic "share your location" copy — independent of whatever address is/was on the Home screen	High
SHARE-14	"Share Locate Link" content is address-independent	Home screen was previously showing a specific address (e.g. address A)	1. Open menu → "Share Locate Link" 2. Inspect content preview	Message does not contain address A (or any specific 3-word address) — confirms this is a generic "locate me" link, not a snapshot of the current pin	High
SHARE-15	Share is available with no network connectivity	Device in airplane mode / Wi-Fi+mobile data off, a location was already displayed before going offline	1. Tap "Share" (Home) or "Share Locate Link" (menu)	Share sheet still opens with correct text content (message construction is local); note whether the share sheet's own app list still populates correctly offline	Medium
SHARE-16	Share button state with no location permission granted	Location permission denied/revoked for the app	1. Launch app 2. Observe Home screen / attempt to tap Share	Define & verify actual behavior: either a fallback/default address is shown and remains shareable, or Share is disabled/hidden with a clear reason — flag as a gap if behavior is undefined	Medium
SHARE-17	Share icon/label accessibility	Home screen and menu displayed	1. Inspect the Share button's accessibility metadata (e.g. via UiAutomator content-desc)	Both entry points expose meaningful accessibility labels ("Share this address", "Share Locate Link") for screen-reader users	Low
SHARE-18	Shared address matches across Home-screen Share and Copy-address actions	Home screen showing address <code>///word.word.word</code>	1. Tap "Copy address" and paste elsewhere 2. Tap "Share" and inspect content	The 3 words from Copy and from Share are identical — no divergence between the two "get the current address out of the app" paths	Low

UI / visual design conformance

ID	Title	Preconditions	Steps	Expected Result	Priority
SHARE-19	Share entry points match the design spec	Design mockup/Figma spec available; Home screen and menu both displayed	1. Compare the Home screen "Share" button and the menu's "Share Locate Link" item (icon, label, position, spacing, color) against the design file	Both match spec; flag any visual diff (icon swap, wrong color/copy, misaligned spacing)	Medium

Recipient-side link behavior (cross-device / cross-user)

Confirmed behaviour (verified with a recipient device):

- **App installed** → tapping the shared link opens the what3words app directly to the shared location (address link) or the recipient's own location (generic Locate Link).
- **App not installed** → the link opens in the browser instead; there is **no** redirect/prompt to the Play Store or App Store.

ID	Title	Preconditions	Steps	Expected Result	Priority
SHARE-20	Recipient with the app installed opens a shared link	Recipient device has what3words installed	1. Open a shared address link (w3w.co/...) 2. Separately, open a shared Locate Link (locate.what3words.com)	Address link opens the app directly at the sender's shared location; Locate Link opens the app and resolves to the <i>recipient's own</i> current location, not the sender's	High
SHARE-21	Recipient without the app installed opens a shared link	Recipient device does not have what3words installed	1. Open a shared address link 2. Separately, open a shared Locate Link	Both open in the browser showing the correct location/behavior (address link → sender's location; Locate Link → prompts for the recipient's own location); no app-install prompt or store redirect occurs	High

Device / OS matrix coverage

ID	Title	Preconditions	Steps	Expected Result	Priority
SHARE-22	Share feature works across different devices	At least 2 physical devices/emulators from different manufacturers (e.g. Samsung, Pixel)	1. Repeat the core Share flows (SHARE-01–04, 12–14) on each device	Share sheet opens and content is correct on every device tested; no device-specific crash or layout issue	Medium
SHARE-23	Share feature works across different OS versions	At least 2–3 devices/emulators spanning the supported OS version range (oldest supported → latest)	1. Repeat the core Share flows (SHARE-01–04, 12–14) on each OS version	Share sheet invocation and content are correct on every OS version tested; flag any version-specific regressions (Android's share-intent/deep-link handling has changed across versions)	Medium

Notes / Assumptions

- SHARE-08, SHARE-15 involve third-party app or OS-level behavior partially outside what3words' control; scope the assertion to "what3words handed off the correct intent/content", not to the third-party app's own behavior.
- SHARE-16 documents a real open question from exploration — permission-denied behavior for Share was not directly observed and should be verified before relying on any assumption here.
- Confirmed via live exploration: SHARE-01 through SHARE-04, SHARE-12, SHARE-13, SHARE-14. The remainder are standard coverage extensions (state changes, edge cases, accessibility, resilience) that follow directly from the two confirmed flows but were not all individually re-verified live during this pass.
- **SHARE-19 (design conformance)** requires the actual design spec (Figma/mockups) as the source of truth — I did not have access to one during exploration, so this is a checklist-style case to run once a designer/PM hands over the spec, not one I've verified against anything concrete yet.
- **SHARE-20/21 (recipient-side link behavior)** — confirmed with a recipient device: app installed opens the app directly at the correct location; app not installed opens the browser instead, with **no** Play Store/App Store redirect or install prompt. Worth flagging to product/design as a potential gap (a share feature with no install nudge for new users is a discoverability/growth miss), even though it's working as observed.

- **SHARE-22/23 (device/OS matrix)** need a device farm or a matrix of physical devices/emulators beyond the single device available here — these describe the coverage strategy rather than a fully executed pass.
- **"Onboarding complete" (SHARE-01's precondition) = dismiss ad banner → select language (English UK) → close login/signup screen**, confirmed via live exploration. There is no separate "Welcome" splash screen to dismiss in the current app — the framework had a `WelcomePage` page object for one, but it was never referenced by any fixture/test and never observed live, so it's being removed as dead code rather than reflecting a real onboarding step.